

The Lost Little Aurora

The snowlit fjords of the north run deep and blue between white mountains and dark green pines, dotted with cosy longhouses whose windows glow warm amber against the snow. Above them arches the Great World Tree, and on clear nights the sky dances with the colours of the aurora. The fjords are full of gentle wonders: a chattering squirrel who carries messages along the tree, two thoughtful ravens, light spirits who dance in the dark, and frost giants who look fearsome but are mostly just cold and lonely. Here a hero is not the strongest or the loudest, but the one who keeps a warm heart, dreams up ideas, and shares the fire. The grandest deeds are done by being brave and kind and full of ideas, and even a giant met with a friendly word often turns out lonelier than it is fierce.

The answers are here. This part is for the grown-up, not for the child.

Show the matching picture in the Atlas as you reach each place.



Read aloud, slowly and warmly. Stop often to let the children answer. There are no wrong answers here, only brave new ideas to try.

Before you begin

It is winter in the fjords, and the long night should be full of colour. On clear nights the Aurora Spirits dance, and the sky glows teal and green and purple. But tonight the sky stays dark. Something is wrong.

The littlest Aurora Spirit has tumbled down from the sky. She fell into the snowy Whispering Pines, and she lost her colours. Now she is too shy and too cold to glow.

Edda the Saga-Keeper calls you to the warm Hearth Hall. "You two have bright ideas and kind hearts," she says. "Will you find the little aurora and help her shine again?"

She gives you three gifts: a little lantern, a ball of red yarn, and a warm honey bun. Then she smiles. "Up here we do not win by being the strongest. We win by being brave, kind, and full of ideas."



What is your hero name? Are you a hero of Imagination, of Courage, or of Heart?

Stop 1 The Dark Forest

You step out into the Whispering Pines. The snow is deep and soft. The tall trees stand dark and quiet all around you.

Somewhere in here, the little aurora is hiding. She is shy and cold and very, very small. You will have to look closely to find her.



How will you find her? Could you move softly and look for a tiny glimmer of light? Could you follow little footprints in the snow? Could you ask Nori the Tomte, the hearth sprite in the red cap, to help?

When you look gently, you spot a soft glimmer behind a tree. There she is, the littlest aurora, no bigger than your two hands, dim and shivering. "Hello," you whisper. "We came to help you."

Stop 2 The Three Colours

The little aurora is happy you found her. But she cannot glow. "I lost my three colours when I fell," she says sadly. "Teal, and green, and purple. They are hiding in the world now."

Look around. The colours did not go far. They are all near you.



Can you find her three colours? Where is teal? Where is green? Where is purple? Look at the icicles, look at the pines, look up at the sky.

You find teal in a shining icicle. You find green in a dark pine branch. You find purple high up in the twilight sky. One by one, the little aurora gathers her colours back. She begins to glow,

soft and warm.

Stop 3 The Climb to the Sky

The little aurora glows now, but she is still afraid. "The sky is so high," she says. "What if I cannot reach it? What if I fall again?"

She needs your courage to lend her some of her own.



How will you help her be brave? Could you climb a tall pine with her? Could you cheer her on? You have a ball of red yarn. Could you give her a gentle boost up?

You climb the tallest pine. You tie the red yarn so she can hold on. You count together, one, two, three. "You can do it!" you call. The little aurora takes a deep breath, lets go, and leaps up into the dark.

The Sky Dances Again

Up she flies, higher and higher, glowing bright. The other Aurora Spirits swoop down to meet her, laughing. "You came back! You came back!" they sing.

Then the whole sky bursts into colour. Teal, and green, and purple, all dancing together over the snowy fjord. The long night is dark no more.

High among the stars, Freya the Kind looks down and smiles at you. You did it together. You were full of ideas, you were brave, and most of all, you were kind. Well done, heroes of the fjords.

The Lost Little Aurora: Rules for the Grown-Up

New to this? Read the Guide for the Grown-Up first. It explains the whole idea in two pages and you will never need it again.

You are the Game Master, which here means a few small jobs at once: storyteller, gentle referee, the children's biggest fan, and a fellow adventurer who plays along. This is a cooperative game for two or more who play together, a grown-up and one or more children, all on the same side. Nobody competes, and nobody loses. This is a gentle tale, soft and warm, where good ideas and kindness win every time and no one is ever truly hurt.

Setting up

- Print the map. Each player puts a small figure on the Start, the Hearth Hall.
- This world has no magic. Instead each hero leans on one of three qualities: **Imagination** (dreaming up ideas), **Courage** (a steady heart), or **Heart** (caring for others). On the hero sheet, where it says magic, let each child write the quality they like best. Two different qualities work best together.
- Give each player five energy stars (five small tokens or bricks). They are spent and refilled during play.
- Set out three props if you can: a small light or token for the little lantern, a ball of red string for the red yarn, and any small thing at all for the honey bun. Anything can be anything.
- Keep your dice and the dice-band table from the back of the kit beside you.

Difficulty bands, not dice

Challenges never call for a particular die. Each one has a band: **Easy**, **Normal**, or **Hard**. When the players try something, look up the band on the kit's dice-band table, which tells you the number to meet or beat with whatever dice your family owns. Every challenge can be played with a single ordinary die.

The golden rule: here nobody loses

A failed roll is never a defeat. It is a detour to a different route. When a roll does not meet the band, the players always have a way through:

- **Spend an energy star** to gather themselves and try the idea again, or
- **Join two qualities** once per stop to pass with no roll at all (Imagination and Heart together, say, or Courage and Imagination).

Energy stars come back when the players move on to the next stop, and when they help each other. Nobody can ever run dry for long, and nobody is ever stuck.

Helping each other: the Helping Hand

At any moment one player may help another instead of acting alone. When they do, make the help roll: on a success the challenge is passed for the pair, even if the first roll missed.

Helping is generous, so reward it; it also tops up an energy star. In these fjords, no hero stands alone.

The Twist of Fate

At each stop, once, the players may roll for a twist and you read out the matching line. Use whichever die the dice-band table gives you for this; with a single ordinary die, read the line that matches the number rolled.

Roll	Twist of Fate
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1	Nori the Tomte pops up and gives you one free hint.
2	You find your courage again, and take back one energy star.
3	A friendly wind off the fjord, and the next challenge is Easy.
4	The Two Ravens fly over and nod kindly. All is well.
5	A lucky strand of red yarn: keep one roll to use again later.
6	A burst of warmth from the hearth, and for a moment everyone feels brave.

How it ends

The little aurora is too shy and too cold to glow, but she is no villain and there is no foe in this tale at all. It is won not by beating anyone but by finding her, helping her gather her three colours, and lending her the courage to leap back into the sky. Let the kindness land; it is the whole point. See the puzzles page for the three challenges and their solutions.

The Lost Little Aurora: Puzzles and Solutions

For your eyes, not the children's. Each stop lists its band, what the players need to work out, the intended solution, and a gentle fallback so a stuck child always moves forward. More than one good idea should work; reward imagination and kindness over the "right" answer.

Stop 1: The Dark Forest (Easy)

The challenge. The littlest Aurora Spirit is hiding among the snowy pines, shy and cold and very small. The players must find her without frightening her away.

Intended solution. This is a moment for Observation and Heart. The thoughtful, kind move is to slow down and look gently: watch for the faint glimmer of her light, follow small footprints in the snow, and speak softly so she is not scared. Asking **Nori the Tomte**, the red-capped hearth sprite, for a hint works just as well.

Fallback. If the children cannot spot her, have her own light flicker for a moment behind a particular tree, or let Nori peek out and point with a wink. The gentlest look or the kindest word brings her out; any honest attempt to find her counts as a full success and tops up an energy star.

Stop 2: The Three Colours (Normal)

The challenge. The little aurora has lost her three colours, teal, green and purple, and cannot glow until the players help her gather them back. Each colour is hiding in something in the world that wears it.

Intended solution. This is an Observation and Logic moment. The good idea is to match each colour to the world around them: **teal** from a shining icicle, **green** from a dark pine branch, and **purple** from the deepening twilight sky. Naming any sensible source of each colour works; the point is matching colour to thing, not one single correct object.

Fallback. If they are stuck on a colour, let the little aurora glance hopefully toward the right place ("an icicle catches her eye"), or have Nori hum and tip his head at it. Each colour found makes her glow a little brighter, and finding them with help still counts in full.

Stop 3: The Climb to the Sky (Normal)

The challenge. The little aurora glows again, but she is afraid to rise. She fears the sky is too high and that she will only fall once more. The players must help her find the courage to climb a tall pine and leap back up.

Intended solution. This is a Heart and Courage moment. Any warm encouragement works: climbing the tallest pine alongside her, cheering her on, counting her up to the leap, or using the **red yarn** to give her a gentle boost up into the air. When the children lend her their courage, she takes a breath and leaps.

Fallback. If she hesitates, or the children are unsure how to help, have her ask quietly, "Will you count with me?" A single kind, brave word is enough. The moment the players cheer her on in any way at all, she gathers herself and rises.

The ending

There is no battle and no loser. When the little aurora leaps back into the sky, the other **Aurora Spirits** swoop down to welcome her home, and the whole night sky dances with teal, green and purple over the snowy fjord. High among the stars, **Freya the Kind** smiles down. The heroes have won the only way anyone wins here, by being brave, kind, and full of ideas.

Wander and Tales

Tale Book

<https://github.com/agigante80/wander-and-tales>

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Here nobody loses. If a try does not work, find another way.